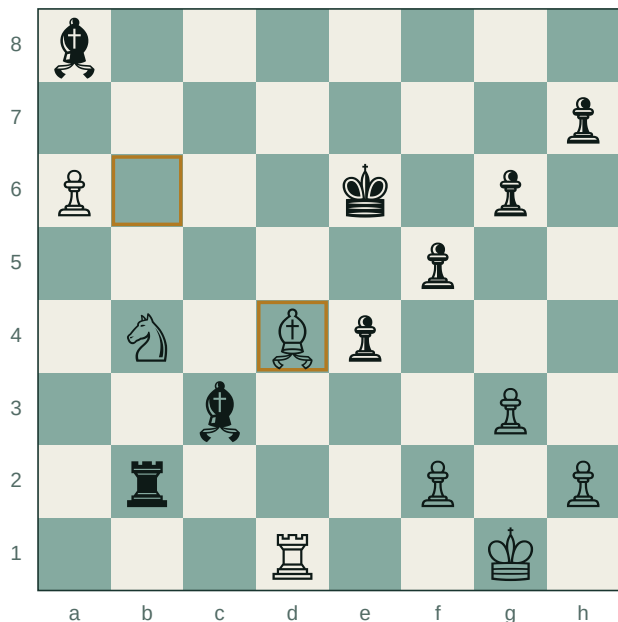


# Discovered checks: Black, move 36

Discovered checks

Black to move



Previous move: 36.Bd4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**36...Bxd4 37. Rxd4 Rb1+ 38. Kg2 e3+**

**36...Bxd4** The bishop captures the bishop on d4. Recorded reply: **37.Rxd4**.

**37...Rb1+** Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. From b1 it attacks king on g1 and knight on b4. Recorded reply: **38.Kg2**.

**38...e3+** Check restricts White to 6 legal replies here. The changed line means the bishop on a8 attacks the king on g2.

At the end, nominal material is White 12 / Black 12 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

## CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +0: the balance goes from +0 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

## CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The checking line must actually be clear, and moving the blocker must not expose your own king to check.

## WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A discovered check opens a line toward the king by moving the blocking piece. Because check must be answered, the moving piece may gain a free tempo for another threat.

## HOW TO LOOK

Trace the hidden checking line first. Then examine where the blocker can move to attack or capture something important.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: knight on b4 and rook on d1. Check for tactical protection.